

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<thought>

To solve this problem , we need to understand the patient's symptoms . The patient feels that his life is cursed , and he often thinks of very negative things happening to him . This indicates a pessimistic outlook , which is more consistent with mood disorders than personality disorders .

</thought>

<answer>

A . The patient is at risk for double depression .</answer>

<thought>

Double depression refers to an episode of major depressive disorder that occurs within a year after an initial episode . The patient describes a long -lasting sad mood and difficulty in making decisions , which suggests a chronic depressive episode . The suicidal ideations and worsening of symptoms in the past two weeks further support the hypothesis of a depressive episode .

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